THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — SOCIAL SCIENCE · PRACTICE QUESTION PAPER

Mid-Term / Half-Yearly Examination · Session 2026–27 · Set 05

Class: 8	Subject: Social Science	Set 05	Time Allowed: 2 Hours 30 Minutes	Max. Marks: 60

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper is divided into six sections – A, B, C, D, E and F.
3. Section A contains Question No. 1 with 15 sub-parts, all Multiple Choice Questions. Each sub-part carries 1 mark. Choose the correct option.
4. Section B contains Question Nos. 2 to 5, which are very short answer questions carrying 2 marks each. Answer each question in at least 20 words.
5. Section C contains Question Nos. 6 and 7, which are short answer questions carrying 3 marks each. Answer each question in about 40–60 words.
6. Section D contains Question Nos. 8 and 9, which are long answer questions carrying 5 marks each. Answer each question in about 80–100 words.
7. Section E contains Question Nos. 10 to 13, which are source/case-based questions carrying 4 marks each (1+1+2). Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow.
8. Section F contains Question No. 14, a map-based question carrying 5 marks. Mark the given locations on the map using appropriate symbols/signs.
9. No overall choice has been provided in the question paper; however, internal choices are given in some questions. Attempt only one option in such questions.
10. For Visually Impaired students, a separate question has been provided in place of Question No. 14. It is to be attempted only by Visually Impaired students.
11. Maintain neatness and clarity while writing answers.

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The 'paradox of plenty' is another name for the — **(1)**

(A) Doctrine of Lapse (B) natural resource curse

(C) demographic dividend (D) token currency

(ii) India's unique high-quality steel, famous across the world, which combined local resources with human skill, was called — **(1)**

(A) Damascus brass (B) Wootz steel (C) Bessemer steel (D) Cast iron

(iii) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option. **(1)**

1. Death of Aurangzeb
2. Battle of Saraighat
3. Battle of Haldighati
4. First Battle of Panipat

(A) 3, 4, 2, 1 (B) 4, 2, 3, 1 (C) 4, 3, 1, 2 (D) 4, 3, 2, 1

(iv) Which ruler of the Eastern Ganga kingdom repelled several Sultanate inroads and built the Surya temple at Konark partly to mark his victories? **(1)**

(A) Narasimhadeva I (B) Krishnadevaraya (C) Rana Kumbha (D) Harihara

(v) The 'hundi' of medieval India was — **(1)**

(A) a tax on non-Muslims

(B) a land grant to officers

(C) a written order to make payment to a person, usable across political borders

(D) a copper coin of Muhammad bin Tughlaq

(vi) The Adnyapatra (1715), which declares 'Forts are the core of the state', was written by — **(1)**

(A) Shahji (B) Kanhoji Angre
(C) Mahadji Shinde (D) Ramachandrapant Amatya

(vii) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option. **(1)**

Statement I: Shivaji sacked the Mughal port of Surat twice.
Statement II: Ahilyabai Holkar ruled from Pune and rebuilt the Kashi Vishwanath temple.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

(viii) Under the Subsidiary Alliance, an Indian ruler had to — **(1)**

(A) pay chauth and sardeshmukhi to the Marathas
(B) hand over his capital to the Company
(C) maintain British troops at his own expense and conduct foreign relations through the British
(D) give up his army to the Nawab of Bengal

(ix) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option. **(1)**

Assertion (A): The railways built under British rule were not primarily meant to benefit Indians.
Reason (R): They were designed to carry raw materials to ports and British goods to the interior, and were largely paid for out of Indian taxes.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

(x) After the annexation of her kingdom, Begum Hazrat Mahal of Awadh finally took refuge in — **(1)**

(A) Bhutan (B) Nepal (C) Burma (D) Afghanistan

(xi) In a First-Past-the-Post election, 100 votes are shared by four candidates as 34, 30, 20 and 16. Who wins? **(1)**

(A) The candidate with 34 votes (B) The candidate with 30 votes
(C) No one, since nobody has 50 votes (D) The candidate with 16 votes

(xii) The Vice President of India is elected by — **(1)**

(A) an electoral college of members of both Houses of Parliament
(B) the people directly
(C) the MLAs only
(D) the Lok Sabha only

(xiii) The 86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002 (Article 21A) paved the way for the — **(1)**

(A) Right to Information Act
(B) Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009
(C) Money Bill of 1956
(D) Model Code of Conduct

(xiv) If a Union law and a State law conflict on a subject in the Concurrent List, which one prevails? **(1)**

(A) The State law (B) Whichever was made earlier
(C) The Union law (D) The one the Governor chooses

(xv) A 'supply chain' means — **(1)**

(A) a chain of retail shops owned by one person
(B) a bank loan paid in instalments
(C) a government list of exports
(D) the network of individuals, organisations, resources, activities and technology involved in production and sale

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) What was wootz steel? Why is it an example of resources combined with skill? **(2)**

O R

2.(B) How has India largely avoided the 'natural resource curse'? **(2)**

3. What was the hundi system? Why was it important? **(2)**

4. State any two differences between the Legislature and the Executive. **(2)**

5.(A) What two aims did Timur state for his invasion of India? What was its result? **(2)**

O R

5.(B) Why is Rana Sanga remembered? By whom was he defeated? **(2)**

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three features of the resistance offered to the Delhi Sultanate by the Eastern Gangas and the Musunuri Nayakas. **(3)**

O R

6.(B) Describe any three features of the economy of India during the Sultanate and Mughal periods. **(3)**

7.(A) Explain any three ways in which the Marathas revived Indian culture and language. **(3)**

O R

7.(B) Describe any three contributions of Tarabai to the Maratha cause. **(3)**

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain the 'drain of wealth' from India during British rule. Mention any five points. **(5)**

O R

8.(B) Evaluate the legacy of European colonialism in India in five points. **(5)**

9. Explain the responsibilities of a business towards the environment and its workers. Mention any five points. **(5)**

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Vrikshayurveda is an ancient Indian science on the care of plants and trees. The word joins 'vriksha' (tree) with 'ayurveda' (science of life). Texts such as Surapala's Vrikshayurveda (around the 10th century CE) advise which plants suit which soils, how to collect and store seeds, how much to irrigate in each season, and how to use natural pest repellents. They also recommend crop rotation and mixed cropping, and ploughing that keeps soil moist and protects fungi, bacteria and earthworms.

Questions:

(10.1) Which two Sanskrit words join to form 'Vrikshayurveda'? (1)

(10.2) Name one natural method mentioned in the passage for protecting crops from pests. (1)

(10.3) How is such traditional knowledge useful today? Give two points. (2)

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Babur, a descendant of Timur, was driven out of Samarkand and turned to India. In 1526, he defeated Ibrahim Lodi at the First Battle of Panipat using gunpowder, field artillery and matchlock guns, and founded the Mughal Empire. In his candid autobiography, the Baburnama, he found India a land of few charms, yet he admitted that it had masses of gold and silver and countless artisans and workmen of every sort.

Questions:

(11.1) Name the autobiography written by Babur. (1)

(11.2) Whom did Babur defeat at the First Battle of Panipat? (1)

(11.3) What did Babur appreciate about India's economy? Explain with two points. (2)

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In 1835, Thomas Macaulay wrote his Minute on Indian Education. Although he admitted he had no knowledge of Sanskrit or Arabic, he claimed that a single shelf of a good European library was worth the whole native literature of India and Arabia. His aim was to create a class of people 'Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, in opinions, in morals, and in intellect'.

Questions:

(12.1) In which year was Macaulay's Minute on Indian Education written? (1)

(12.2) What kind of class of Indians did Macaulay want to create? (1)

(12.3) How did this policy affect traditional Indian education? Give two points. (2)

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In the 2024 general elections about 980 million Indians were eligible to vote, spread across 543 constituencies. Yet about 34 per cent of eligible voters did not cast their vote. Experts point to voter apathy, especially in cities, the growing influence of money, and the number of candidates with criminal records as challenges. They urge informed voters, awareness campaigns, and the participation of young people.

Questions:

(13.1) How many Lok Sabha constituencies are there in India? (1)

(13.2) What percentage of eligible voters did not vote in 2024? (1)

(13.3) Suggest any two ways of increasing voter participation. (2)

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5) **(5)**

(I) Daulatabad
(II) Saraighat (Guwahati)
(III) Thanjavur
(IV) Jhansi
(V) Panna diamond mine
(VI) Zawar zinc mine

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Daulatabad located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Saraighat located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Thanjavur located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Jhansi located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Panna diamond mine located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Zawar zinc mine located? 1

